

IAA SETI Committee
Declaration of Principles Vote (2025–2026)
Summary Report on Voting Process & Outcomes

Background

The IAA SETI Committee conducted a formal vote on the updated “Declaration of Principles Concerning the Conduct of the Search for Extraterrestrial Intelligence (SETI) – 2026 Update” (version dated 27 November 2025). The vote was administered using the Helios secure electronic voting system.

Voting Period

- **Voting opened:** 2 December 2025
- **Voting closed:** 31 January 2026

Eligible Voters

- **Total eligible voters:** 91

Participation

- **Total ballots cast:** 57
- **Voter turnout:** 63%

Voting Question

Members were asked:

“Do you approve the new ‘Declaration of Principles Concerning the Conduct of the Search for Extraterrestrial Intelligence (SETI) – 2026 Update’ (version: 27 November 2025)?”

Results

- **YES:** 53 (93.0% of votes cast)
- **NO:** 1 (2% of votes cast)
- **ABSTAIN:** 3 (5% of votes cast)

Outcome

The Declaration of Principles was approved by a substantial majority of participating voters.

Process Integrity

- The vote was conducted using Helios, a cryptographically secure, auditable electronic voting platform.
- Ballots were anonymous and no personal voting data are disclosed.
- The election was administered and decrypted in accordance with established Helios procedures.

Prof. Michael Garrett,
IAA SETI Committee Chair.